

Metropolitan Planning Commission Meeting May 7th, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=tM9lxvg6_7I
Publication Date	2026-05-08T11:03:51Z
Target Category	delaware_county

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Delaware-Muncie Metropolitan Plan Commission Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: May 2026

Body: Delaware-Muncie Metropolitan Plan Commission

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The presiding officer called to order the May Delaware Muncie Metropolitan Plan Commission meeting [00:00:07](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Stephen Brand, Nate Carroll, Jerry Dishman, Teresa Hensley, Richard Ivy, Emily Kring, and Chris Smith (total of 7 voting members present, establishing a quorum).
 - **Members Absent:** Tom Borchers, Owen Lecher, Jesse Landis, Adam Leach, and Ricky Sipe. (Note: Tom Borchers submitted remote comments read into the record later).
 - **Presiding Officer:** Not explicitly named in opening remarks.

3. Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance 00:00:13.
 - **Approval of Minutes:** The April 2026 meeting minutes were reviewed and approved by a roll call vote of 7-0 00:02:15.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

00:03:38 MPC 04-26Z: Zoning Map Amendment (Wheeling Avenue Church of the Nazarene)

- **Item Identifier & Title:** 00:03:38 MPC 04-26Z <U+2014> Consideration of an appeal filed by Wheeling Avenue Church of the Nazarene requesting a change in zone from R-2 (Residence Zone) to BV (Variety Business Zone) at 4600 North Wheeling Avenue.
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad Warner (Studio 22 Personal Training, operating under contract with the church).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The applicant explained plans to move an established personal training business across the street into the existing brick building to build equity. The operation is by appointment only, open weekdays from 7:00 a.m. to 7:00 p.m., with low volume (typically 25 to 40 people per day, peaking at roughly a dozen vehicles at any given time). The applicant noted intentions to blacktop a gravel auxiliary parking area behind the building.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:**
 - **Dan Ridenour (Mayor of Muncie, 300 N. High St.)** 00:08:03 spoke in *support*, noting he is a former client who benefited from the low-volume, appointment-only personal training.
 - **Kenneth Huffman (1807 W. Godfrey Ave.)** 00:09:25 spoke with *concerns*, noting 48 years of residence in the quiet neighborhood. He questioned what might happen to the property's business zoning if the current applicant ever closed or became ill, expressing opposition to high-traffic commercial uses like fast food or gas stations.
 - *Applicant Rebuttal:* Brad Warner returned to clarify that his long-term intention is to operate the wellness facility until retirement and subsequently sell the business and building as a running fitness operation, acting as a quiet community buffer 00:12:20.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved with a Favorable Recommendation (Passed 7-0) 00:14:23. Forwarded to the City Council for final action on June 1st at 6:00 p.m.
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00:15:05 BZA 16-26: Special Use Expansion (DCRT, LLC)

- **Item Identifier & Title:** 00:15:05 BZA 16-26 <U+2014> Consideration of an appeal filed by DCRT, LLC requesting an expansion of a charitable institution special use to allow a counseling and medical service center in a residence zone at 2517 West 8th Street (former Forest Park School).
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jay Doitchman, Manager for DCRT, LLC.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The applicant is under contract to purchase the former Forest Park School property (currently housing the Muncie Senior Center and the Veterans Project) to close within 60 days. The project involves renovating approximately 25,000 square feet in the rear of the building to add outpatient counseling (addressing PTSD, behavioral health, and co-occurring disorders), continuous education, a gym, and medical services. The Muncie Senior Center will remain in place under a \$1-per-month lease arrangement, with DCRT covering building expenses. The center will expand operations to 7 days a week, adding an estimated 70 daily visitors through intensive outpatient programs (IOP) and partial hospitalization programs (PHP).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:**
 - **Julie Meeks (Executive Director, Muncie Delaware County Senior Center)** 00:25:24 spoke in *support*, detailing high building maintenance expenses (\$58,000 last year) that threatened the center with abandonment. She praised the partnership as a solution to integrate desperately needed on-site medical and mental health counseling for seniors.
 - **Patrick Romack (Resident & Veterans Project representative)** 00:28:31 spoke in *support*, highlighting the desperate need for veteran suicide prevention, mental health resources, and relief for the senior center's operating budget.
 - **Dan Ridenour (Mayor of Muncie)** 00:33:32 spoke in *support*, noting multi-year administrative efforts to save the deteriorating historic property and commending the developer's track record with historic preservation and veteran support.
 - **Bob King (Property owner nearby at 2501, 2405, and 2517 W. 8th St.)** 00:33:15 expressed support for the senior center and historic preservation, but voiced traffic concerns regarding children/school buses and requested that the use remain strictly restricted to medical and counseling services rather than pivoting to general substance abuse rehab.
 - *Board/Staff Clarification:* Staff and legal counsel clarified that special uses are tied strictly to the approved application/use parameters, and the Board of Zoning Appeals holds the authority to place binding operational conditions on the special use grant.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved with a Favorable Recommendation (Passed 7-0) 00:39:30. Forwarded to the Board of Zoning Appeals (BZA) for final action on May 28th at 6:00 p.m.
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00:40:02 MPC 04-26A: Text Amendment to Rules of Procedure (Vacation of Subdivision Plats)

- **Item Identifier & Title:** 00:40:02 MPC 04-26A <U+2014> Public hearing and resolution of approval to amend the text of the rules and procedure for the Delaware-Muncie Metropolitan Plan Commission regarding vacations of subdivision plats.
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Planning Staff / Legal Counsel Alan Wisely.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Prompted by procedural hiccups encountered during a subdivision plat vacation earlier in the year, legal counsel researched statutory authority and determined that both the Metropolitan Plan Commission and the Plat Commission hold authority to vacate subdivision plats. To streamline the process for applicants and recording offices, the amendment officially transfers plat vacation review authority from the full Plan Commission to the Plat Commission. The board also addressed an email communication from absent member Tom Borchers emphasizing that subdivision vacations must ensure drainage responsibilities and maintenance ownership remain clearly defined. Counsel noted the Plat Commission can enforce and condition approvals accordingly.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Resolution 2026-04 to amend Article 6, Section 8 of Exhibit A approved by Voice/Roll Call Vote (Passed Unanimously, 7<U+2013>0) 00:47:04.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

No general open public comment period or citizen forum was held during this meeting.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - **Legislative Update:** MPC 03-26Z (Renovation LLC rezoning on Northwood Drive) received favorable recommendation on April 2nd and was formally adopted by the County Commissioners on April 20th 00:48:01.
 - **Director's Report:** Highlighted seasonal permit increases (288 permits issued through April 2026); 452 inspections (Thomas); 49 plan reviews; and case totals across boards (BZA: 17, Plan Commission: 6, Plat Committee: 7, totaling 30). Staff member Kayla Ferguson was congratulated on earning her master's degree from Ball State University 00:49:31.
- **Adjournment:** The meeting concluded following staff reports and board congratulations 00:50:16. *(Exact adjournment time not explicitly stated on the record).*

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